



Re: 2025 - 2026 Civil Grand Jury Report - "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended"?

From Michael Tabak <mtabak@smcgov.org>

Date Thu 8/20/2026 11:15 AM

To Darcy Smith <dsmith@portolavalley.net>

Hi Darcy,

I apologize for my delayed response. I have formulated the Sheriff's Office response to the Grand Jury report. It is currently under review by County Counsel and our Executive Team. Once I get the "ok" and it's finalized, I will make sure you get a copy which you can use to develop any response you may be required to provide.

Best,



Mike Tabak, Captain
San Mateo County Sheriff's Office
San Carlos Police Bureau
Peer Support Group
600 Elm St.
San Carlos, CA 94070
(650) 802-4239
www.smcsheriff.com

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From: Darcy Smith <dsmith@portolavalley.net>

Sent: Wednesday, August 12, 2026 9:28 AM

To: Michael Tabak <mtabak@smcgov.org>

Subject: FW: 2025 - 2026 Civil Grand Jury Report - "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended"?

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Hi Captain Tabak,

I am reaching out about the 2025–2026 Civil Grand Jury report "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended?" and the response the Town of Portola Valley has been asked to prepare. Please see my message below. This is not urgent, but I want to ensure we are coordinated.

Hope you are doing well.

Best,



Darcy Smith
Town Manager
Town of Portola Valley
765 Portola Rd
Portola Valley, CA 94028
Phone: (650) 851-1700 x 215
Email: dsmith@portolavalley.net
[Schedule a Meeting with Me](#)

From: Brandon Hensel <bhensel@smcgov.org>
Sent: Tuesday, August 11, 2026 2:51 PM
To: Darcy Smith <dsmith@portolavalley.net>
Subject: RE: 2025 - 2026 Civil Grand Jury Report - "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended"?

Hi Darcy,

Thank you for the email, and I completely understand the desire for the Town's response to be in alignment with that of the Sheriff's Office. Captain Michael Tabak is responsible for overseeing the Sheriff's Office Flock ALPR contract and he will be preparing the response for our organization. You can reach him via email at: mtabak@smcgov.org

Hope all is well and you enjoyed your vacation!

-Brandon



Brandon Hensel, Captain
San Mateo County Sheriff's Office
Headquarters Patrol Bureau
330 Bradford Street
Redwood City, CA 94063
650-363-4990
www.smcsheriff.com

From: Darcy Smith <dsmith@portolavalley.net>
Sent: Tuesday, August 11, 2026 12:57 PM
To: Brandon Hensel <bhensel@smcgov.org>
Subject: FW: 2025 - 2026 Civil Grand Jury Report - "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended"?

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Hi Brandon,

I'm reaching out regarding the attached 2025–2026 Civil Grand Jury report "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended?" and the response the Town of Portola Valley has been asked to prepare.

The report's camera inventory table (page 3–4) lists Portola Valley under the San Mateo County Sheriff's Office's 109-camera deployment, along with a note that the total "includes unincorporated SMC (except Broadmoor), Portola Valley, San Carlos and Millbrae." Unlike San Carlos and Millbrae, however, Portola Valley does not have any ALPR cameras physically sited within our Town boundaries. It appears the report may be grouping PV together with jurisdictions that do have cameras under the SMCSO contract, when in fact PV's situation is distinct as we receive contracted law enforcement services from SMCSO but have no in-Town camera infrastructure.

The Town Council has also been placed on the Request for Responses list, tied to Findings F3, F5, F6, F7, F8, F9 and Recommendations R3, R5, R6, R7, R8, R9. This is the same set directed at San Carlos and Millbrae, despite this difference.

Before the Town files its response, I want to make sure our office and yours are aligned. My response is going to state that the Town has no in-Town cameras. Who on your team is preparing SMCSO's response, so we can stay coordinated as both offices finalize our submissions? It would be great if I can connect with them. This is not urgent, as responses are not due until October.

Thank you for your help sorting this out.

Best,



Darcy Smith
Town Manager
Town of Portola Valley
765 Portola Rd
Portola Valley, CA 94028
Phone: (650) 851-1700 x 215
Email: dsmith@portolavalley.net
[Schedule a Meeting with Me](#)

From: Jenarda Dubois <jdubois@sanmateocourt.org>
Sent: Tuesday, August 4, 2026 10:17 AM
To: Darcy Smith <dsmith@portolavalley.net>
Subject: 2025 - 2026 Civil Grand Jury Report - "Is Our Flock of ALPR Cameras Properly Tended"?

You don't often get email from jdubois@sanmateocourt.org. [Learn why this is important](#)
Good afternoon,

Attached is a 2025-2026 Civil Grand Jury report and cover letter that pertains to your agency. Kindly follow the guidelines of the letter when responding to the findings and recommendations of the report.

Cordially,

Jenarda Dubois



JENARDA DUBOIS (She/Her/Hers)
Human Resources Analyst
Superior Court of California – County of San Mateo
(650) 261-5693

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